The eulogy for Sylvia, one of the "immortal" combatants of the "Caesarea" unit, provides a small peek into the profession of running combatants.

The spouses of the Mossad's employees and combatants live in the shadow of their partners. The eulogy for Leika, Kokla's wife, reveals a touch of the world of the Mossad employees' wives.

Shlomo Gal was the ultimate operations man, who began his life in Israel as a child refugee of the Holocaust and grew up to command the Mossad's top operational unit.

I also include in this chapter remarks (not a eulogy) that I delivered on the occasion of Yitzhak Shamir's ninety-fifth birthday, in which I spoke, inter alia, about the nature of the relations between the head of the Mossad and the prime minister. I also deal with this issue in chapter 4's section on the negotiations for a peace treaty with Jordan, which were led by the late Yitzhak Rabin.

Meki Evron (Israel Intelligence Heritage and Commemoration Center, February 18, 2004)

The time line of his life passed through Ben-Shemen, the British army, the Palmach, the IDF, and the intelligence community. Meki's is a breed that is disappearing into the pages of the history of the Land of Israel. The members of this breed were role models for my generation. We saw them as the fulfillers of the Zionist dream, the new Israelis, who cast off Diaspora characteristics and became the spearhead of a new species—tall and proud, courageous, reverent toward manual labor, facing down every challenge, breaking conventions, devoting their lives to the people and the state. A species of groundbreakers.

These are people who lived and operated in an environment that was not yet regulated. They were the parents of all beginnings. They set the benchmarks, the precedents, the points of reference, and the standards. They were entrepreneurs, and entrepreneurial traits are individualism, nonconformity, the breaking of rules, the cutting of corners, the finding of shortcuts, and the utilization of the "Jewish genius" to achieve inconceivable feats.